

A large, vertical image on the left side of the page shows a school of small, dark fish swimming in clear, turquoise water. The fish are concentrated in the lower half of the image, moving towards the right. The water is bright and clear, with some light rays visible. The overall tone is serene and natural.

INTRODUCTION

Animals form the largest of the natural world's kingdoms. Although they evolved after other living things, they are now the dominant form of life on earth. Among the attributes that have made them so successful are the abilities to adapt their behavior and to move. This section looks at the features that set them apart from other life forms, how they have evolved, their often complex responses to the world around them, and the way biologists classify them. It also examines the many threats they face.